CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 11

Sage *Montrose*

THREE-TIME PIE CONTEST CHAMPION

"Your crust is flaky. Your patience is not. Your trophy shelf needs a bigger wall."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER · IN EVERY GAME

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a cozy plaid dress, a ribbon rosette and a pie server tucked in your pocket.

Suit style: a tweed vest over a flannel shirt, an apron and the same rosette.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Maple pecan pie

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

- **Before guests arrive:** read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.
- **Appetizers · Round 1:** when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.
- **The Main Course · Round 2:** the lower half of page 3.
- **Pie · Round 3:** page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.
- **Accusation over coffee:** fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are innocent.

You did not harm Goldie. You may still have something to hide.

Your story and your secret

Your prize-winning maple pecan pie is not really yours. Three years ago you copied it, word for word, from a recipe card in Goldie's grandmother's handwriting that was waiting to go into the cookbook. Once the book was published, everyone would know. Last month Goldie found out and said, "Sage, we need to talk." You were ashamed. You never hurt anyone.

Where you were (your alibi)

- 4:40: arrived with your pies and set them on the buffet in the main hall.
- 5:00–5:25: helping Avery set the long table in the main hall.
- 5:25–6:00: in the kitchen with Avery. At 5:30 Goldie ladled gravy from the pot into her silver boat and carried it into the pantry; at 5:58 she carried it out.
- 5:40: you set the oven timer for ten minutes to rewarm your pies. It rang at 5:50, and right after it the pantry's back latch clacked twice, about a minute apart.

Your goal

Clear your name, keep your pie secret until Round 3, and win Best Detective.

If someone asks you…

"Did Goldie ever question your pies?" → "Goldie judged them three years in a row and gave me first prize every time." (True!)

"Where were you at ten to six?" → "In the kitchen with Avery. My oven timer rang at 5:50; ask Avery."

"Are you M.?" → "I'm M. Montrose, yes. I have never even seen the cookbook's bank account."

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

PLAYING TIP

Stay in character and read your Share lines aloud when a round opens. Write down every time you hear on your Detective Notes: someone's story will not match the clock. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet says to share it, but never lie about the evidence.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You have won the county pie contest three years running, and Goldie was the head judge every time.
- At about 5:30 you watched Goldie ladle gravy from the pot into her silver boat, cover it with her napkin and carry it into the pantry. She said, "Nobody touches my boat."

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · Where your pie recipe came from.

Ask

- **Morgan:** "You edited the cookbook. Do you know what Goldie's big news was?"
- **Casey:** "Is Goldie's TV show doing all right?"

Your mission

Ask three guests their favorite pie and promise each of them a slice "for research."

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- From 5:25 to 6:00 you were in the kitchen with Avery. Nobody but Goldie went through the kitchen door to the pantry.
- At 5:40 you set the oven timer for ten minutes. It rang at 5:50, and right after it the pantry's back latch, the mudroom side, clacked twice, about a minute apart. You heard it at no other time.

Ask

- **Jules:** "Who knew where you hung your coat?"
- **Quinn:** "What were you doing in the mudroom?"

Your mission

Start a 5:50 timeline on your Detective Notes and compare it with two other players.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- Your secret (see Evidence #12): your prize pie is Grandma Ashby's recipe, word for word. Goldie found out. You were ashamed, not dangerous, and you never left the kitchen.
- You are "M. Montrose," but you have never handled the cookbook's money.

Ask

- **Quinn:** "Who looks after the cookbook money?"
- **Morgan:** "Where were you at ten to six?"

Your mission

Offer the first slice of pie to the best detective so far, and tell everyone why.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES